

Urn Placement Options

Columbariums, ground burial, and the other resting places available for cremated remains at Washington Memorial Park.

SECTION 1

What Is a Columbarium?

A dignified above-ground resting place for cremated remains

A **columbarium** is a structure with individual compartments — called **niches** — designed to hold urns containing cremated remains. Columbariums offer a permanent, secure, and elegant alternative to scattering or in-ground burial.

Placement carries charges beyond the niche or garden space itself. The **Cemetery Property Guide** walks through the space, endowment care, opening and closing, and the rest.

Each niche is sealed with a **granite or bronze faceplate** that can be engraved with the name, dates, and a personal inscription. **Every niche at Washington Memorial Park carries the right to place two urns** — there is no separate single-urn niche here. The one exception is the **Veterans Court of Honor**, where each niche holds one.

Washington Memorial Park features five columbarium locations, each with its own setting and character. Families are welcome to visit any time during park hours.

SECTION 2

Columbarium Locations

Five unique settings throughout Washington Memorial Park

Garden of Meditation

OUTDOOR COLUMBARIUM

A serene outdoor garden with curved columbarium walls surrounded by mature landscaping. One of the park's most visited and established areas.

- Every niche holds two urns
- Granite faceplates with engraving included
- Landscaped garden setting with benches
- Located near the main chapel

Rock of Ages Columbarium

OUTDOOR COLUMBARIUM

A striking natural-stone columbarium built into the hillside, offering a distinctive and sheltered setting with panoramic views of the park.

- Every niche holds two urns
- Natural stone walls with granite faceplates
- Hillside location with park views
- Quiet, reflective atmosphere

Mountain View Columbarium

INDOOR/OUTDOOR COLUMBARIUM

A modern columbarium offering both indoor and outdoor niche options, with views of the Cascade foothills. One of our most popular locations for companion placements.

- Indoor and outdoor niches available
- Climate-protected indoor options
- Mountain and park views
- Two urns per niche, indoor or outdoor

Radiance & Serenity

INDOOR GLASS-FRONT COLUMBARIUM

An elegant indoor columbarium featuring glass-front niches, allowing families to see the urn and any keepsakes placed inside. A popular choice for families who want a more personal display.

- Glass-front niches — urn is visible
- Indoor, climate-controlled setting
- Space for keepsakes and photos inside niche
- Every niche holds two urns

Eternal Light Columbarium

INDOOR COLUMBARIUM

A peaceful indoor columbarium with warm lighting and a contemplative atmosphere. Niches are sealed with engraved granite faceplates.

- Indoor, temperature-controlled environment
- Warm, inviting lighting
- Granite-sealed niches with engraving
- Year-round visitation comfort

Terrace Garden Ossuary

COMMUNAL PLACEMENT

A shared resting place where cremated remains are placed together in a communal garden. An affordable option for families who value simplicity and community.

- Communal placement — remains are commingled
- Commemorative plaque with name and dates
- Beautiful garden setting
- Most affordable urn placement option

Ground Burial of an Urn

Two ways to do it, and what the urn itself has to be

Cremated remains do not have to go into a columbarium. They can be buried, and there are two quite different ways to do that here.

In a standard grave space

ANYWHERE IN THE CEMETERY

An urn can be placed in an ordinary grave space, in any section of the park. If a family wants to buy an available casket plot and place an urn in it, they can — and a single space will hold **up to three urns**.

This is what families choose when they want to be where their family already is, or when they want room for more than one person in one place.

- **One, two, or three urns** in the same space
- **Additional cost for the second and third** — each placement is its own interment, so ask us to price the number you have in mind
- **Any section** — including beside family already at rest here

Lake Urn Garden

BUILT FOR URN BURIAL · AT THE FRONT OF THE CEMETERY

Some sections are built specifically for urn burial rather than for caskets. At Washington Memorial Park those are in the **Lake Urn Garden**, near the front of the park.

These spaces are sized for cremated remains and hold **one urn per space**. They are the more affordable option, and they sit in a quieter, more compact setting than the main burial sections.

- **One urn per space**
- **Endowment care** — perpetual grounds maintenance
- **Opening & closing** and **recording fee**
- **Flush granite marker** — quoted separately (see the Marker Guide)

WHAT THE URN ITSELF HAS TO BE

Anything buried in the ground has to be able to survive being there. For a ground placement you have two choices, and either one satisfies it:

- **Put the urn inside an urn vault** — a small outer container that protects it underground. This lets you bury an urn that was not made for burial, including a wood or a ceramic one. See the **Burial Vault Guide** for the urn vault options and prices.
- **Or choose an urn rated for burial** — the marble urns shown under “Urn for Ground Burial” in the **Cremation Guide** and the **Urn Catalog** are made to go straight into the ground.

Choosing the Right Placement

Key questions to help families decide

Consideration	Columbarium Niche	Ground Burial	Scattering
Permanent marker?	Yes — engraved faceplate	Yes — flush granite marker	Yes — commemorative plaque
Urn visible?	Glass-front option available	No — buried underground	N/A — remains scattered
Companion option?	Yes — every niche holds two urns	Yes — up to 3 urns in a standard space	Yes — same garden
Weather-protected?	Indoor options available	No — outdoor garden	Outdoor
A place to visit?	Yes — dedicated location	Yes — dedicated location	Garden area, less specific

Many families find comfort in having **a specific place to visit**. Both columbarium niches and ground spaces provide a permanent, named location where family members can return for years to come.

SECTION 5

Benefits of Urn Placement at WMP

Why families choose a permanent resting place

A Place to Visit

A permanent place with a name on it that family can visit.

Permanent & Secure

Niches are sealed and maintained. Ground spaces include endowment care in perpetuity.

Companion Options

Couples can be placed together: every niche holds two urns, and a standard ground space takes up to three.

Beautiful Settings

Five unique locations — from hilltop views to glass-front indoor niches.

Personalized Memorial

Engraved faceplates or flush markers with names, dates, and inscriptions.

Pre-Planning Available

Lock in today's pricing and relieve your family of difficult decisions later.

We can walk you through each location in person and help you find the setting that feels right. All urn placements include endowment care, so the grounds and facilities are maintained in perpetuity.



Serving Seattle families since 1868 · Washington Memorial Park

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